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Story Handoff Guide

Use this guide when you need to describe a **journey, process, use case, activity sequence, or business story**.

This guide is about **what happens**, **who is involved**, **what changes**, and **what outcome is reached**.

KNOWLEDGE AREA

This guide helps with **business journeys and scenarios**.

Guide family map

Where this guide sits in the full Blueprint Handoff Atlas family.

ROOT & CROSS-CUTTING

Handoff Atlas | Blueprint Bundle | Metamodel Vocabulary | Migrations

DESIGN

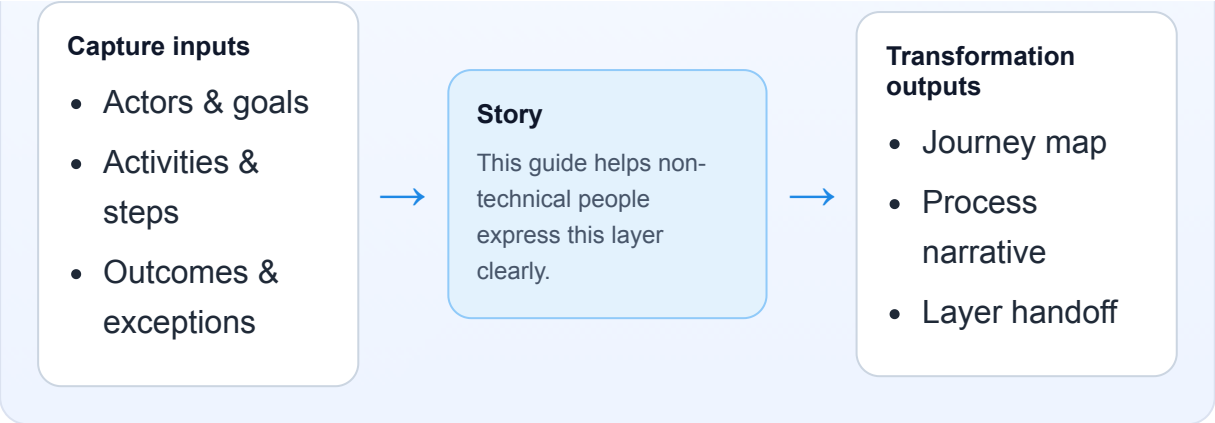
Architecture | Concepts | Domain | Dynamics | Infrastructure | Interactions | Models | Quality | Rules | **Story**

GOVERNANCE

Capability | Decisions | Motivation | Organization | Roadmap | Leverage | Test Cases | Value Stream

Capture → focus → transformation

What to gather first, what this layer focuses on, and what a modeler or AI agent can produce from it.



Main entities in this guide

- **Story** - a full business journey or scenario from trigger to outcome.
- **Activity** - a meaningful chunk of work inside a story; steps live inside the activity.
- **User Story** - a concise user-centered need, often phrased as value for an actor.
- **Use Case** - a structured interaction goal with actors, trigger, and expected result.
    - Often confused with: **Transition** in the Rules guide. A story activity or step tells the journey; a transition tells which state change is allowed.

What belongs here

Capture things like:

- a user journey
- a business process
- a service flow
- a use case
- a sequence of activities and steps
- success, error, and exception paths

What does not belong here

- full definitions of business concepts - put those in the Concepts guide
- detailed screen behavior - put that in the Interactions guide
- formal rules and constraints - describe them here only briefly and link them conceptually

Core things to capture

Describe:

- **who** starts the story
- **why** the story exists
- **what activities** happen
- **what steps** happen inside those activities
- **what triggers** the next part
- **what success looks like**
- **what can go wrong**
- **what other concepts, screens, or rules are involved**

Core relationships to capture

Make these links explicit in your text:

- actor -> story
- story -> activity
- activity -> step
- step -> next step or next activity
- story -> concepts involved
- story -> screens/interactions involved
- story -> outcomes, risks, or rules that matter

Modus operandi

When eliciting a story, work in this order:

1. name the **goal**
2. identify the **actor**
3. describe the **main happy path**
4. split the flow into **activities**
5. add important **steps** inside each activity
6. add **exceptions**, **errors**, and **alternate paths**
7. list the concepts and screens involved

Focus on the business meaning of the flow, not on technical implementation.

Prompt set

Use questions like these:

- who wants something to happen?

- what starts the flow?
- what is the first meaningful activity?
- what happens next, and why?
- what is the expected outcome?
- what can fail?
- what other people or systems take part?
- what business concepts are changed, read, or created?

Free-text intake template

Use this template when gathering notes:

- **Story name:**
- **Goal:**
- **Primary actor(s):**
- **Trigger:**
- **Main outcome:**
- **Activities:**
    - Activity 1:
        - purpose:
        - steps:
        - result:
    - Activity 2:
        - purpose:
        - steps:
        - result:
- **Error or alternate paths:**
- **Concepts involved:**
- **Screens or interactions involved:**
- **Important rules or risks:**

Worked example

Example: customer submits a return request

- **Goal:** a customer requests a return and receives a decision
- **Primary actor:** customer
- **Trigger:** customer decides to return an item from a completed order
- **Main outcome:** return request is approved or rejected
- **Activities:**
    - Create request

        - customer selects items and reason
        - system records the request
    - Review request
        - system checks policy and eligibility
        - system approves automatically or routes for manual review
    - Notify customer
        - system sends the decision
- **Error or alternate paths:**
    - request falls outside the allowed return window
    - request is missing item selection
    - request is rejected because the product is non-returnable
- **Concepts involved:** customer, order, return request, refund decision
- **Screens involved:** order details page, return request form, confirmation/decision screen

Layer-specific handoff guidance

For stories, the handoff should preserve the **narrative and outcome flow**.

The receiver should be able to tell:

- who wants what
- what the happy path is
- where the important exceptions are
- what concepts and screens the story touches

If the notes read like disconnected steps rather than one coherent journey, improve the handoff before transformation.

How this becomes YAML

A technical modeler or AI agent can transform this into a story layer by:

- turning the story into a named business narrative
- turning activities into ordered story activities
- mapping key steps to business operations
- linking actors, concepts, and screens
- separating happy path and error path behavior

You do not need to produce IDs or YAML field names yourself.

Common mistakes

- listing steps without the overall goal
- mixing several unrelated stories together
- describing only the happy path
- naming activities but not the result of each activity
- using UI button names instead of business actions
- forgetting which concepts are affected by the story